Workstation Setup & Verification Report

Nicholas Lui
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1. System Specifications

Component	Specification
OS	Windows Server 2025 Datacenter, Version 24H2, Build 10.0.26100.33650
CPU	AMD EPYC 7571, 2 vCPUs
RAM	8.00 GB
Storage	50 GB NVMe, AWS EBS
Network	Amazon Elastic Network Adapter ENA, DHCP IPv4
Admin Account	cloud_user
Standard User	Nicholas Lui, OBT Techbridge Student

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2. OS Configuration & Hardening

- **Display, Power, and Accessibility:**
  Checked display scaling and set sleep and display timeouts to Never so long tasks and Remote Desktop Protocol sessions do not drop. Reviewed Accessibility text size settings and kept them at default levels.
  Evidence: Screenshot 01 - Display, Screenshot 02 - Power, Screenshot 03 - Accessibility
- **User Account Setup:**
  Created a standard local user named Nicholas with the full name Lui and description set to OBT Techbridge Student in Computer Management. Added the account to Users and Remote Desktop Users so it can sign in through Remote Desktop Protocol for coursework while maintaining standard user privileges.
  Evidence: Screenshot 04 - New User Account, Screenshot 05 - Group Membership
- **Password Policy:**
  In Local Security Policy, verified password complexity is Enabled so accounts cannot use weak

credentials.
Evidence: Screenshot 06 - Password Policy

- **Windows Update:**
  Checked Windows Update and confirmed the system is up to date.
  Evidence: Screenshot 07 - Windows Update

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3. Application Setup & Non-Default Settings

1. 7-Zip 64-bit

- **What I Changed:** Turned on 2 Panels Mode using F9 under View.
- **Why:** Lets you view two folders side by side inside the app, making it easier to drag and extract files without having to open multiple windows.
- Evidence: Screenshot 08 - Install, Screenshot 09 - 2-Panel Layout

2. Notepad++

- **What I Changed:** Switched the theme to Dark Mode in Preferences.
- **Why:** Dark mode is easier on the eyes after staring at a computer screen for a long time and in the dark during night time.
- Evidence: Screenshot 10 - Install, Screenshot 11 - Dark Mode Setting

3. Mozilla Firefox

- **What I Changed:** Set Homepage and new windows to Blank Page.
- **Why:** Firefox usually loads news, shortcuts, and background feeds when opened. Setting it to blank stops background data from loading and makes startup faster.
- Evidence: Screenshot 12 - Install, Screenshot 13 - Blank Page Setting

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4. Verification & Testing

- **Concurrent App Launch:**
  Opened 7-Zip, Notepad++, and Firefox at the same time to make sure they all run smoothly without crashing or freezing.
  Evidence: Screenshot 14 - All 3 Apps Running
- **Standard User Account Check:**
  Logged in under the new Nicholas user context and ran whoami in Command Prompt. It returned ec2amaz-nmhb9o6\nicholas, confirming the standard user profile works properly without admin rights.
  Evidence: Screenshot 15 - whoami Nicholas
- **Network & DNS Check:**
  Ran ping 8.8.8.8 and it timed out with 100% packet loss because the AWS EC2 security group blocks outbound ICMP ping packets by default. Ran nslookup google.com right after, and it

resolved successfully to 142.250.177.238 through the AWS DNS server 172.31.0.2, proving internet connectivity and DNS are working.
Evidence: Screenshot 16 - Ping timeout and nslookup resolution

- **Screenshots Folder Inventory:**
  Opened the Desktop\Week5_Screenshots folder in File Explorer showing all 17 numbered screenshots saved and organized.
  Evidence: Screenshot 17 - Folder Contents

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5. Deliverables List

ID	File Name	Description
01	01_display_settings.png	Display resolution and layout
02	02_power_settings.png	Power and sleep timeouts set to Never
03	03_accessibility_settings.png	Accessibility text size settings kept at default
04	04_new_user_account.png	Nicholas account in Computer Management with name and student description
05	05_user_group_membership.png	Member Of showing Users and Remote Desktop Users
06	06_password_policy.png	Password complexity Enabled in secpol
07	07_windows_update_verified.png	Windows Update showing up to date
08	08_app1_install_7zip.png	7-Zip installed and opened
09	09_app1_config_7zip.png	7-Zip with 2-panel view enabled
10	10_app2_install_notepadpp.png	Notepad++ clean install
11	11_app2_config_notepadpp.png	Notepad++ Dark Mode enabled
12	12_app3_install_firefox.png	Firefox clean install
13	13_app3_config_firefox.png	Firefox home and startup set to Blank Page
14	14_verification_apps_launch.png	7-Zip, Notepad++, and Firefox open simultaneously

15	15_verification_user_login.png	whoami showing ec2amaz-nmhb9o6\nicholas
16	16_verification_network.png	Terminal showing ping timeout plus successful nslookup
17	17_screenshots_folder_contents.png	Screenshots folder showing files 01 through 17